

Name: _____

Date: _____

Mr. Rawson • Y9 MYP Design



Criterion A — Inquiring and analysing

How your summative is marked — written in class Wednesday 7 October

Criterion A is marked **out of 8**, in **four strands**, and your summative asks you to do all four. **Keep this sheet.**

Read *down* a column to see how one strand gets better. Read *across* a row to see what a whole level looks like. The green row at the bottom says what each strand means **on this project**.

Level	i • the need <i>...for a card, rather than a problem</i>	ii • the research plan <i>...before you design anything</i>	iii • analysing <i>...products that inspire your card</i>	iv • the design brief <i>...built from your research</i>
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors below.			
1–2	states the need	states some of the main findings of your research	—	—
3–4	outlines the need	states the research needed — with some guidance	outlines one existing product	develops a basic brief, outlining some of the research
5–6	explains the need	constructs a plan that states and prioritises primary and secondary research — with some guidance	describes a group of similar products	develops a brief that outlines the findings of the research
7–8	explains and justifies the need	the same plan, done independently	analyses a group of similar products	develops a brief that presents the analysis of the research
On our project	Who is your card for, and why does one you built beat one off a shop shelf?	Look at real cards, and ask the person it is for what they want. Then say what matters most.	Analyse three real cards. Strengths <i>and</i> weaknesses.	Who it is for, what tone, and what your card is — grown out of your research.

The words that move you up — the strand barely changes between levels, the *verb* does:

states you wrote it down
outlines you gave the short version
describes you said what it is really like
explains you said *why*
analyses you broke it apart
justifies you argued for it

Where the marks actually go. Not one mark on this page is for how good your card *looks*.

Criterion A is marked entirely on **the thinking you write down before you build anything** — who it is for, what you found out, and what that means for your design.

Nobody moves up a band by making a prettier card. They move up by **writing more carefully about the cards they looked at**.

What You Actually Hand In

Six pieces — and which strand each one feeds

Every piece below feeds one of the four strands on the front. Nothing here is padding.

✓	What you hand in	Strand	How long	What takes it from 5–6 to 7–8
☐	1a Five things that make a card good, each with an example	ii	20–50 words <i>each</i>	Be precise. “Nice picture” is worth nothing. Say <i>what</i> you mean, and name a real card where it worked.
☐	1b Your research plan	ii	—	Put it in order. Both primary <i>and</i> secondary research, ranked, with a sentence saying why the top one is top.
☐	Part 2 Three real cards , aimed at clearly different people. Three criteria, one per card	iii	30–60 words <i>per criterion</i>	Strengths <i>and</i> weaknesses. An analysis that only praises is not an analysis.
☐	Q5 Who was each card designed for, and how can you tell?	iii	1–2 sentences <i>each</i>	Point at the <i>evidence on the card</i> . Not “it’s for a child” — “it’s for a child, because the words are big and there are only six of them.”
☐	Q6 Why does your card need to exist?	i	—	Justify it, don’t just explain it. Say what yours does for this person that a shop card could not.
☐	Q7–9 Your design brief — who, what tone, and the card in a sentence	iv	—	Present the analysis , not just the findings. See the box below.

The one thing that decides your grade: describing is not analysing.

Strand iii is your biggest block of writing, and all of it turns on this.

Saying “*the picture is nice*” tells a reader almost nothing. Saying **why** it works, and **what effect** it has, is what turns a description into an analysis.

Weak *The card has a nice picture and a funny message.*

Strong *The front is a badly-drawn dog with one ear up, and the wobbly line makes it look hand-drawn rather than printed — as if a friend made it. The joke is held back until you open it, so the front makes you curious rather than giving it away. It is aimed at an adult who likes being teased, not a child.*

The strong one does three things, **in this order**:

what is actually there → **the effect it has** → **who it is for.**

Do those three every time, and strand iii looks after itself.

Before you hand it in

- ☐ All **four** strands are answered — i, ii, iii and iv.
- ☐ My three cards are for **genuinely different** people.
- ☐ Every card has a **weakness**, not only praise.
- ☐ My research plan is **in priority order**, and says why.
- ☐ I said why my card beats **one off the shelf**.
- ☐ My design brief says “**so**” at least once — “*people like funny cards, **so** mine leads with the joke.*”